

Starter Spencer Sits and Thinks, Then Gets Beat

By LESTER KOELLING

An unusual sight greeted you as you walked into the dressing room of the Indianapolis Indians 30 minutes before game time last night.

George Spencer was sitting in a chair before his locker. Usually, he's out on the field, hitting fungoes, shagging flies or throwing on the sidelines. But this was different — in many ways.



Koelling

Spencer was to forsake his customary haunts in the left field bullpen. He was to be the starting pitcher—for the second time in three years and only about the fourth time in the last five seasons. How did he feel?

"Well," started George, "it's different. Here I am sitting and thinking about those Charleston hitters: You plan on how to pitch to each one. You don't do that when you're relieving. You just get ready, try to get the ball over and get 'em out."

(Spencer lasted 5½ innings against the Senators, giving up six runs and eight hits in what eventually became a 10-4 Charleston victory.)

"The big difference in relieving and starting is the way you condition yourself," continued Spencer. "When you're a starter you do a lot of running between starts because you know that you'll be in there only about every fourth or fifth day. But you can't do that when you're a reliever because you're apt to be in there any time."

Is there any psychological reaction or any stomach flutters when you're a starter?

"Sure," replied Spencer. "When you know you're going to start you have a chance to sit and think. I was told two hours ago that I was going to start, and I've been thinking about it ever since. You don't get that in the bullpen because you never know if and when you're going to be called."

As far as the mechanics of pitching are concerned, Spencer does not think there is any great difference.

"Once you throw that first ball," he said, "you might as well be relieving as starting. It's no different then. It's the period before the game when things are different."

If they tried, the Indians couldn't have looked worse in their performance behind Spencer, Bill DuFour and Al Papai. It was their most ragged demonstration of the season as they committed mechanical and mental errors, ran the bases badly and permitted Bob Shaw, the Charleston hurler, to go the route for the first time this season.

But it wasn't because the Indians weren't trying. They were trying too hard. It was quite obvious that they were tight and pressing, overly eager to compensate for their poor showing on the current home stand.

It was quite obvious, too, to Manager Andy Cohen, who held his first postgame club meeting of the season. After reading the riot act, he dismissed the boys with a decree to "get out of here, relax and I don't want to see anyone around here until tomorrow night."

The Indians have been working diligently, long and sincerely to get out of their present plight. Yesterday, for example, Neil Chrisley, Ron Jackson, Jim Delsing and Sam Mele came out to the park voluntarily for special batting practice. They hit for two hours and last night their hands were taped to cover the blisters from the strenuous work-out.

No matter how bad they'll go, or how long, no one can ever accuse the Indians of not trying. Again, they're trying and working too hard.

TRIBE BOX SCORE

CHARLESTON (10)

	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E
Faccini, ss.....	5	0	0	0	1	6	0
Risley, 3b.....	4	0	1	2	1	1	0
Phillips, 2b.....	5	0	1	2	2	0	0
A. Wilson, lf.....	4	0	2	2	2	1	0
Clark, if.....	1	0	0	0	0	0	0
Thorpe, rf.....	5	0	1	1	1	0	0
B. Wilson, cf.....	5	0	1	2	3	0	1
Stewart, 1b.....	4	1	2	2	1	0	0
Griffin, c.....	3	1	1	1	4	0	0
Shaw, p.....	3	0	1	1	0	4	0

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Run for A. Wilson in 7th.

INDIANAPOLIS (4)

	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E
Valdivieso, ss....	5	0	0	0	3	2	2
Garcia, 2b.....	4	0	0	1	2	2	0
Beard, cf.....	4	0	0	1	5	0	0
Jackson, 1b.....	4	0	0	2	6	0	0
Delsing, rf.....	4	0	1	2	2	0	0